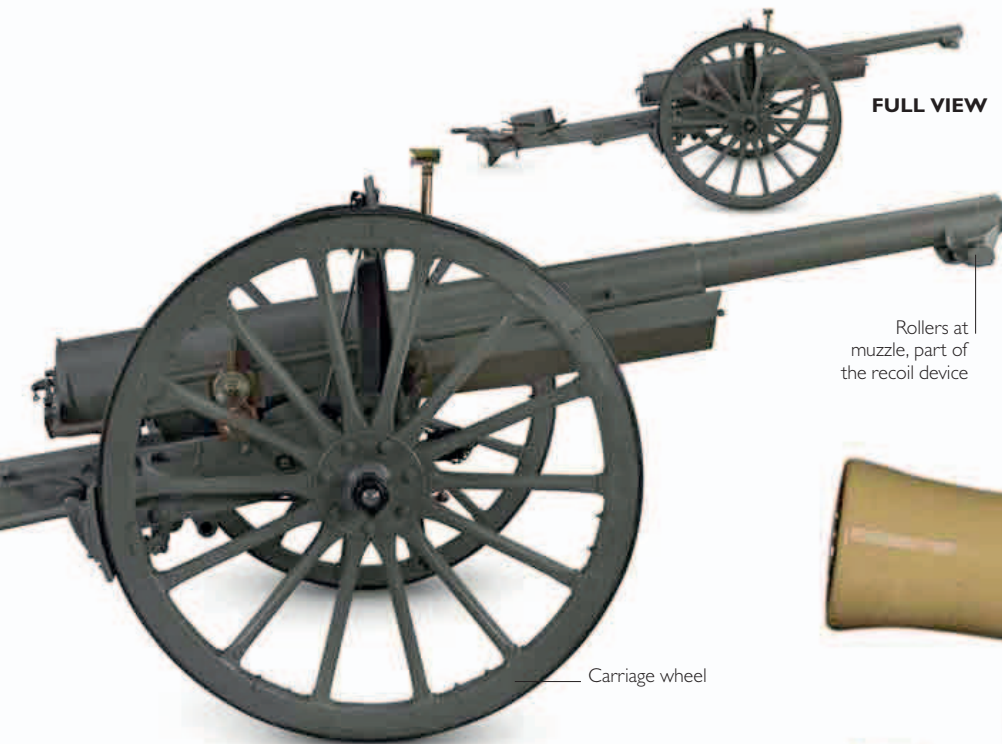


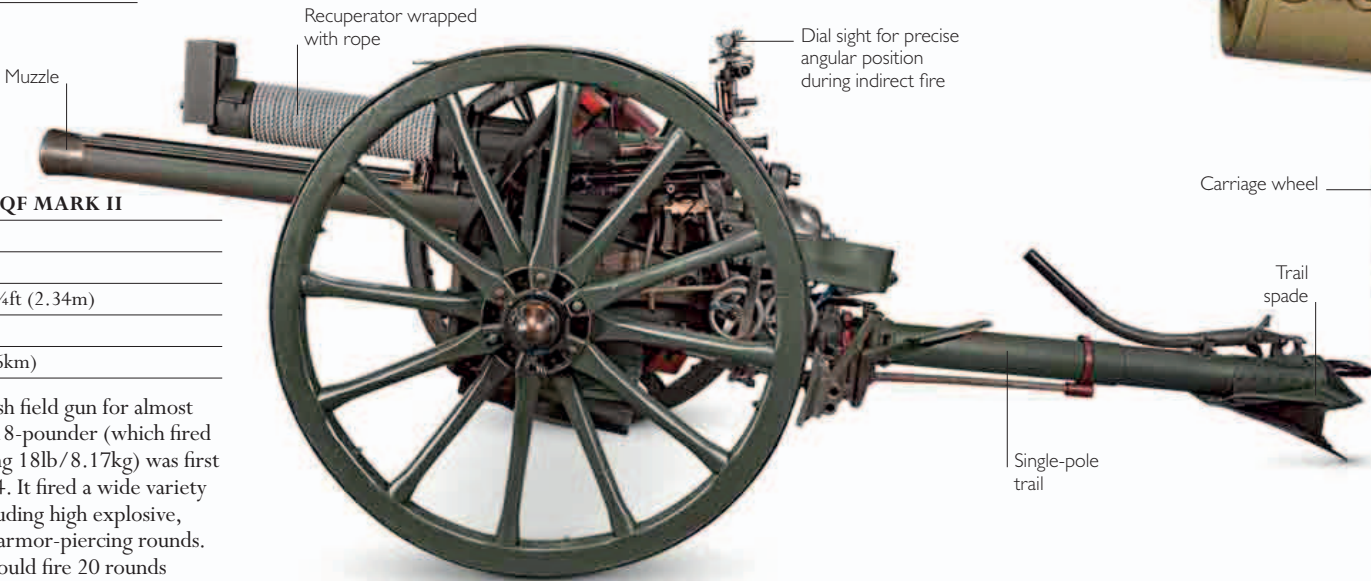
ARTILLERY (1897–1911)

In Europe there were some key requirements that guided the development of field guns at the end of the 19th century. Almost all artillery was horse-drawn, which limited the weight of the gun and its mobility. Armed forces also demanded greater range and accuracy. To achieve this, mechanisms to control the recoil of the gun were developed so that the trail and wheels were still while firing, and all the force of the exploding charge was directed forward. At the same time, Quick-Fire guns (see p.216) evolved, achieving rates of fire of 20 rounds per minute or more.



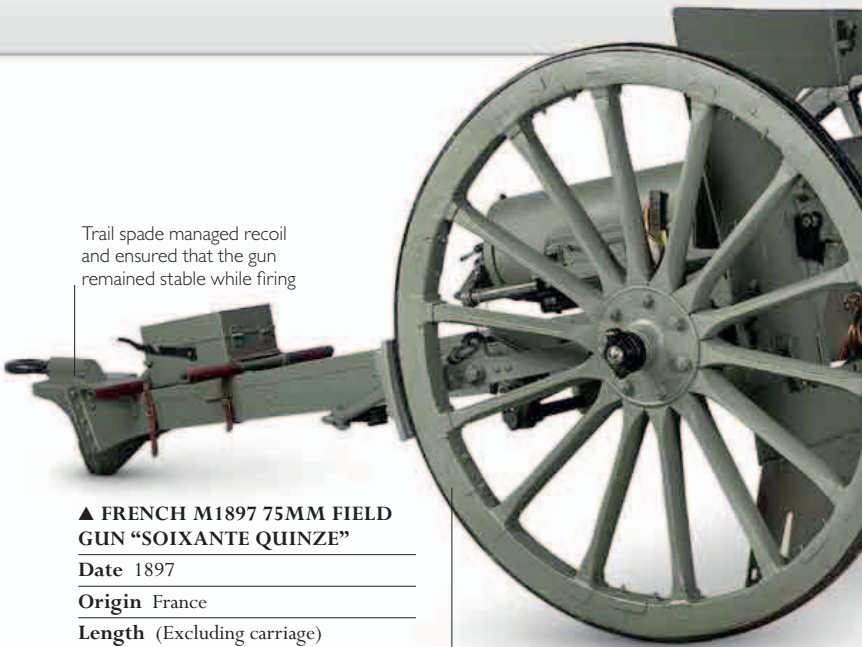
▲ **FRENCH CANON DE 75MM MODÈLE 1897**
Date 1897
Origin France
Length (Barrel) 8¾ft (2.7m)
Caliber 75mm
Range 4¼ miles (6.9km)

The Canon de 75mm Modèle 1897 used a hydropneumatic recoil mechanism that worked like a shock absorber and kept the trail and wheels stationary when firing. Widely regarded as the first modern artillery gun, it could fire 15 rounds per minute.



► **18-POUNDER QF MARK II**
Date 1904
Origin UK
Length (Barrel) 7¾ft (2.34m)
Caliber 3.3in
Range 3¾ miles (6km)

The standard British field gun for almost four decades, the 18-pounder (which fired projectiles weighing 18lb/8.17kg) was first introduced in 1904. It fired a wide variety of projectiles, including high explosive, shrapnel, gas, and armor-piercing rounds. Its six-man crew could fire 20 rounds per minute for short periods.



▲ **FRENCH M1897 75MM FIELD GUN "SOIXANTE QUINZE"**
Date 1897
Origin France
Length (Excluding carriage) 14¾ft (4.5m)
Caliber 75mm
Range 4¼ miles (6.9km)

This Quick-Fire gun incorporated a hydropneumatic recoil mechanism, which kept the gun's trail and wheels still during the firing sequence. In addition, the gun had a rapid-opening screw breech. These factors allowed it to achieve a rate of fire of 15 rounds per minute.

Wooden carriage wheel

Barrel could be depressed to -15 degrees and elevated to +22 degrees

